Minutes NZRA general meeting, Christchurch, Monday 4 February 2013

Present: Pete Squires, Bill Kennedy, Dave Laurie, Grant Hunter, Emma de Lacey,
Apologies: Trevor Merrifield

NZ Champs 2012 – Mahinerangi – confirming accounts

- Trevor Merrifield had handed on the accounts for this event.
- Net result was a loss of $162.75, a very good result given the modest participation (75 and 44) and higher costs associated with remoteness of location, noting that much of the field work was done from Christchurch.
- These accounts were endorsed, with the proviso that there may be some additional costs related to yet-to-be confirmed retrieval of the last check points.

NZ Champs 2013

- At the November national meeting of NZRA it was agreed this would be a 24 hour event, this year in the North Island.
- Davie Laurie reported that since the November meeting he has collected a set of OCAD maps for each or most NZ Champs events, and advised Nick.
- At the time of the February meeting there had been no feedback by NI reps on progress.
- Dave Laurie is to subsequently follow up with Nick Collins*. Other options include Mark Copeland (advisory on venue and possible organisers) and Shaun Collins (commercial organiser, Auckland)
- Agreed that if no venue and/or organisers are found, there will not be a 24 hour Championship event in 2013.
- The meeting was unwilling to hold the event in the South Island as an alternative as this did not resolve the issue of building the wider capability to stage larger events, just delaying the crux.
- Noted that if it is desired to hold a 12 hour event (versus 24 hr) as a championship event, the committee will need to reverse its decision from November. This would come with a range of implications, as indeed does not holding a championship at all.

(*After the meeting, feedback via Dave Laurie is that Nick has found no interested parties to be the core of organising an event, and he sees limited potential and will to commit. Various threads are being followed up by various committee members.)

NZ Rogaining Series

- Individuals in separate areas have expressed interest in working toward NI and SI series, eventually leading to a national series. However, those interests tend to be locally focused, with no sign yet of an emerging consensus on how it might operate as a regional series.
- The meeting therefore felt the time is not yet right to think in terms of regional-scale series, and that emphasis in the short term is best on ensuring and supporting individual events.
- This is a significant and disappointing result since the committee had hoped that a regional/national series framework was the preferred way to further build rogaining on a national scale.

IRF Levies

- IRF has flagged a per-head formula based on membership or sanctioned events. This will not work under NZ area as we do not have membership and definition of NZRA-sanctioned' is variable.
- Nick has advised IRF that there is a need for a re-think. Await further advice.

IRF representation

- Alan Holdaway has indicated he is willing to step down as one of two NZ reps on IRF. Agreed this is a matter for the AGM.
- Note that NZRA may change its delegates at any time by notifying the IRF Council in writing.

WRC 2010 (Cheviot) website

- Bill Kennedy asked if it were time to close down the event website.
- We agreed that the website includes much information of enduring value.
- Bill will transfer such information to a position on the NZRA website, before closing down the WRC site. He will use judgement in what to keep/discard.

Australasian Champs

- Confirmed we agree to the ARA proposal, with a NZ event tabled for 2016. This commits NZ to holding a 24 hour championship event in 2016, with date confirmed two years before, with an implication that a 'quality' venue and organising team are also known by then. This sits with Tim Farrant.
- Secretary to write to ARA to confirm our engagement

Other items from November meeting with NZOF

- Grant is beginning to assemble written resources to guide organisers of future events

Other events

Heights of Winter:

- looking like PAPO is struggling to organise this year. They have major orienteering obligations leading to the National Champs they are hosting at Easter.
- NZRA willing to help, but will need to put in place a collaborative arrangement (eg assign responsibilities etc). We are not looking for financial reward.

Office Hours: Grant has been unable to progress this 7 hour event for late summer/autumn. He has venue lined up but this will need to await next summer.

Canterbury Series: Bill to check with Tim Farrant on his plans for this year.

NZRA webserver

- May need to transfer to a commercial (rather than the current goodwill-based arrangement).
- No action needed yet, just to monitor the situation

Facebook

- Traffic fairly quiet as few events being held.
- Grant to check with Chrys Horn and Tim Farrant re their views and respective roles.

AGM

- Confirmed for Monday 25 February, 6 Harrods Court, Christchurch
- Membership to be advised by email newsletter